

Research Summary

Expense Tracker Apps: Research & Application Design

1. What an expense tracker is

An expense tracker captures and categorizes spending so users understand where their money goes. Unlike budget apps, it focuses on historical spending rather than planning.

2. Data capture

- Manual entry
- Receipt scanning (OCR)
- Bank synchronization (future scope)

3. Core features

Automatic categorization, summaries, recurring bill detection, alerts, charts, search, filtering and exports.

4. User behavior

Short daily check-ins and weekly reviews are more sustainable than exhaustive logging. Reducing friction improves long-term adoption.

5. Portfolio application

Version 1 focuses on manual entry, OCR, and intelligent merchant categorization using :

Merchant normalization -> lookup table -> rule engine -> AI fallback -> save mapping -> user correction.